

DISTORTIONS OF THE INSTINCTS OF SELF-PRESERVATION AND PROCREATION

Greetings, my dearest friends. God bless each one of you. God bless this hour.

Tonight I am going to discuss two basic human instincts as they appear in distortion: the instinct of self-preservation and the instinct of procreation. These instincts in their pure form perform a very important role. But where there are psychological problems and immaturities, where there is distortion and unreality, these instincts experience a distortion, and they no longer work constructively.

The instinct of survival, or self-preservation, aims at gaining, maintaining, preserving, improving life. By its very nature, it must work against anything that destroys life or the safety of living. Just as the body aims at health so that it can live, so also does the soul aim at health for its own capacity to live most constructively. In order to live, one needs to be safe from destruction and damage. We know by now that what the healthy soul considers safety is at variance with the consideration of the unhealthy, immature soul in this respect. The unhealthy soul considers any rejection, any withholding of love, admiration, and approval not only as unsafe, but it actually experiences such occurrences as "death." All of you who follow this path and do this work have come across similar emotional reactions. Here you may observe a typical example of how the instinct of self-preservation comes into a wrong channel and manifests erroneously. Your soul believes in order to preserve its life and safety, you have to fight against the illusion of rejection in any form. This fight assumes various forms. One of them is the establishment of the idealized self-image.

The emotional insecurity (experienced to some degree by every child) is destructively fought against by means of the distorted instinct of self-preservation. As you proceed in this work on the path, you learn to become more and more aware of feelings of utter threat even though in your reasoning capacity you know this is exaggerated, irrational, and often entirely untrue. Yet you cannot help feeling threatened, endangered. Inwardly you behave as though your life were at stake whenever a real or imagined slight occurs. This disharmony is the manifestation of your distorted instinct for self-preservation at work, fighting for "soul-safety" or, as it is more commonly called, emotional security. This security or stability is fought for in the wrong way. Instead of building an inner hold and a healthy self-respect that come naturally as a result of removing errors, you inwardly and subtly try to force others to give you security and safety by looking for certain feelings you think they ought to have for you. You fight against emotional unsafety by holding yourself in check and damming your outflowing soul forces because, unconsciously, this seems a protection. In health, the instinct of self-preservation will lead a person to refrain from endangering activity. Inner or outer activity which in itself could be constructive is, in distortion, thought to be dangerous and is therefore not attempted.

This perversion of the instinct of self-preservation brings in its wake further distortions of character trends. Certain faults come into being, according to one's character structure. These are, for instance avarice, an inner or outer tightness, rigidity, prejudice, preconceived ideas -- in short, any trend or inner urge that holds on, that cannot let go. It may manifest on any level of personality. Outwardly for instance, you may be generous in material matters, but in certain areas of your inner life there may exist an emotional avarice and stinginess. If you carefully examine the motions of prejudice and preconceived ideas, you will see that they have the same origin as avarice, stinginess, tightness, with the same ingredient of holding on to something because this appears "safe."

The feeling described here -- of holding on, of tightness -- is not obvious. Even after some time of this work, it will first be felt only vaguely. But as you proceed in self-examination, it will come into clear relief. You will become acutely aware of it and then understand its significance. Here, as in any other aspect of this work, the more you become aware of and understand the cause and effect of negative emotions, the weaker will they automatically become.

Such inner reactions are soul movements. The soul movement of this particular distortion is a tight holding on to forces that should be fluid. It is an inverted, restricting movement that finally leads to stagnation, inner starvation. This may not affect the entire personality. It depends on what areas this distortion exists in and to what degree. This restriction prevents assimilation of new ideas and attitude changes that may be healthy and appropriate and at a later time productive of correspondingly new emotions and new experiences. This restriction makes rigid rules of behavior and attitude, frozen ideas, opinions, feelings, and reactions that will be unable to change as long as this basic distortion is not changed. This amounts to an emotional constipation which may or may not outpicture in the physical area of being.

Regarding the instinct of procreation, I would first of all say, once again, that it includes more than the physical continuation of the human race. It includes every form of creativity, applying to all levels of being. In its healthy form, it reaches out to communicate. It is ready for new eventualities, ready to enjoy, ready to give and receive and to experience pleasure and happiness. In other words, as indicated in one of the recent lectures, man's yearning for pleasure supreme is connected with the instinct of procreation.

In distortion, out of all the psychological difficulties and problems that are not properly assimilated and coped with, out of the pseudosolutions we recently discussed, this instinct also is led into a wrong channel and thereby generates poison. In distortion, the following trends come into being (again according to character structure): acquisitiveness, reaching out to grab and receive (but in a raw grasping way rather than in the healthy way which is flexible and receptive); greed; craving, until finally, in crass cases, leading to addiction. The craving for receiving pleasure, although perhaps completely unconscious, can be so strong that many repercussions occur within the psyche. It is not to be misunderstood that a desire for pleasure, as such, is wrong. It is quite the contrary. The healthy soul will be aware of it and will aim at it, but in a very different way. The more unconscious this craving is, the greater is the havoc within the soul. For instance, it is very possible that a person does not experience any longing for pleasure, fulfillment, happiness. In fact, he may be completely resigned to a life of what he believes to be serene detachment, while, underneath, the craving and dissatisfaction do a great deal of damage. Such superimposed resignation from the longing for pleasure supreme may be expedient because the psyche may feel endangered by giving

vent to it. In such cases, the perverted instinct of self-preservation is stronger. But that does not mean that the perverted instinct of procreation, stifled as it may be, does not do equal damage.

Here you have two distinct soul movements. One is holding on tightly, not letting go that which is obsolete so that new material can be assimilated by the soul. This is the restrictive movement. The other one reaches out, not in a relaxed way, but rather grabbingly, greedily, compulsively.

These soul movements are very subtle. Only this work you are doing can bring awareness of them into your consciousness. Since both distortions are intrinsically self-centered, the reaction on the personality must be of like nature. Self-centeredness brings frustration, anxiety, tension, compulsion, guilt, and insecurity, to name but a few of the negative emotions thus generated. The error is all the more tragic because the psyche erroneously believes that being self-centered would preserve its safety or satisfy the craving. Nothing can be further from the truth. Nothing induces greater insecurity than to be egocentric. This calls for fixed, prescribed behavior patterns and rules, however subtly and vaguely felt may be their existence. When others do not abide by these rules and expectations, the hoped for and planned "safety" crumbles. Besides, the constant fear that others may, perhaps, not abide by it, undermines inner peace. You build on sand and need to rely on that which you cannot control. However, if you are not self-centered, you can afford to be flexible. You can see and experience each situation anew and adjust to its particular needs. Since self-seeking will not be your central focus, you are safe in adjusting to any given situation, person, or unforeseen requirement. In other words, contrary to man's unconscious conviction, safety and security lie in nonself-centeredness. In self-centeredness, you need to be given love, admiration, approval. You have to get. This necessitates planning, preconceived according to your rules and commands. Since life does not work that way, your commands are often not obeyed. When these rules then prove ineffective, your sense of insecurity is increased for a twofold reason. One is you do not receive what, in your self-centeredness, you believe you should receive; and the second is your rules, supposed to be workable, prove unworkable. All the preconceived planning and blueprinting of a situation is therefore bound to make you blind to what really is. It inhibits your spontaneity and intuition and prevents you from adjusting to what could be. And this, incidentally, is often just as good, or even better, than what you had planned. Unfortunately, however, you do not see it because whenever your plans are disturbed, your very life is endangered, or so it seems to you. So do you destroy happiness by the very process that is supposed to obtain it.

Until one advances to these soul areas, understanding their full impact and significance, each time insecurity is increased by the process described, man tends to strengthen the rigid rules and commands, despairing more and more with himself when they prove progressively less workable.

This inner process of preparation, based on an imagined need for safety, stems from the imbalance of inner weight. You focus your entire attention exclusively on yourself. (You may not think so, but emotionally this is so often true.) This one-sidedness is unsafe. But you attempt to eliminate the unsafety not by becoming less egocentric but by becoming more so and by creating regulations supposed to safeguard this egocentricity. Thus you find yourself in another one of those unfortunate vicious circles. True safety comes from seeing the people you have to deal with, not only in theory, but in understanding them emotionally. But this is impossible if you focus your inner attention and weight almost exclusively on yourself.

Again this is such a subtle process, so hard to detect in you. Even though theoretically you may know it quite well and even believe that you are acting upon it within, you must find where this is not so. As a result, you will make a very substantial contribution towards establishing real security and safety. This can be done only by truthfully examining your emotional reactions to certain situations. Whenever you feel any disharmony of any sort, also shyness and timidity, you are bound to find some of these reactions hidden deeply within yourself.

Both these soul currents, being utterly self-centered, cannot experience and take defeat. From the recent lectures and most particularly from the findings you have made in connection with your idealized self-image, you must now know that it is very proud in nature, apart from its other aspects we have discussed. This price cannot admit defeat. Since defeat is occasionally inevitable, when it does come, it threatens the very ground you stand on, the precarious ground and pseudosafety of your idealized self-image. The healthy personality can take defeat. You all have to take it. No one can get away from it. But how you take defeat, that is the question! It is possible that your outer behavior in defeat leaves nothing to be desired. But we are not concerned with the appearance. We are not even concerned with your thoughts. We are concerned with the inner truth, with the inner experience, with what you really feel. And that is not so easy to bring into awareness. It takes considerable will power and self-honesty, patience and perseverance in order to become aware of how you really feel, in connection with this or any other subject. You know that.

It is sometimes easier for a person successfully to experience a big defeat, an important issue in life. But the small daily rejections, failures, defeats may threaten your security and belief in yourself. They may give you a feeling of shame and humiliation that has to be hidden from others so that your defeat will not be exposed. Test yourself as to how you embellish a situation to your friends; how you hide in subtle coloring that which seems painful and humiliating for you; how you belittle others who are supposedly responsible for your defeat so as to save face. All these reactions, and many more, are an indication of how the truth in you looks in this respect, and what your attitude really is to defeat. Test yourself as to how you fear exposure of certain happenings, reactions, and incidents, and to what means you resort in order to avoid it. The examination of these ingrained reactions which have truly become second nature is more difficult than finding deeply hidden and important new insights. Here you have to deal with what is quite on the surface. But you have become so accustomed to the deeper ones that it hardly occurs to you to examine these reactions and behavior patterns.

To experience defeat in a healthy mature way presupposes true humility, not a false one, not a superimposed one. It presupposes a certain generosity of feeling, a certain greatness in that it can admit defeat, and without loss of dignity. This very attitude actually brings on dignity. The child in you believes that the less defeat you suffer, the greater you are. Nothing could be further from the truth. The truth is that you are great to the degree that you cope with defeat -- honestly, humbly, in dignity and poise, without embellishment and coloring, without projection and humiliation, without pretense.

The pretense can go in two very opposite directions, again according to personality structure and according to which of the pseudosolutions has been chosen. If your pseudosolution is the quest for power, then your reaction to defeat will be extreme humiliation that has to be hidden at whatever cost. This very process of concealment takes a very heavy toll on your life giving forces. It induces such guilt and fear of exposure that the effects are too numerous to discuss at this point. You may

or may not succeed in keeping the truth from yourself. Usually it is a combination of half-seeing the deception and pretense towards others and partly being unaware of the extent to which you deceive others as well as yourself in this manner.

One "successful" way of dealing with defeat that cannot be hidden is to belittle others by making them seem responsible so that your defeat becomes theirs. This creates additional guilt in you. The hostility flows in two directions, towards others and to yourself.

If your pseudosolution is the quest for "love" and you are the submissive type, you will aggrandize the defeat. You will dramatize it out of all proportion. It then becomes a means of forcing others to protect and love you.

If your pseudosolution is the quest for "serenity," you will deny the very existence of defeat as long as possible. This is dangerous because of the self-deception; the unawareness of what you really feel; the lack of awareness of why you act in certain ways as a result of this self-deception.

Even if a person has but one of these pseudosolutions as a predominant trend, one or both of the other trends still exist. Hence, it is more than possible that a person will deal with defeat one time in one way and at another opportunity in another. In one area of life, one pseudosolution may prevail, in other departments another; and since it is not chosen at random, the choice may be predictable according to the nature of defeat. All this has to be individually found and applied.

My advice to my friends is for them to ask themselves the question, "How do I really take defeat?" -- not how does it appear, but how do you feel about it, deep inside? Think back recently or into the past. When did something occur that was a defeat for you? And what is or is not a defeat may vary with each person. For one person, a professional setback may not be a defeat. He may not have a problem in this respect. He may have a relatively mature attitude in this area. What to another person would seem as a major personal disaster, as a loss of face, he will not experience and feel as such. Oh, he may regret or dislike any material disadvantage resulting from such defeat, but he will not feel as though his value as a human being, his distorted idea of "dignity" is at stake. But that very same person may perhaps have an overly strong reaction to little incidents, such as a person being not friendly one day, not greeting him, or not being pleasant in one way or another. The incident of not being greeted may, for him, be a defeat. Though he may not think of it as such, his emotional reaction may amount to just that.

So when I invite you to question yourselves as to your attitude towards defeat, do not think of what is generally recognized as such. You have to find what you experience as defeat, humiliation, failure. This may vary with each person. Search in this direction, my friends. For, once you recognize this, a great wave of inner strength must come, as it always does from any healthy self-recognition and insight. Merely by observing your reaction in this respect, you will weaken its negative impact. Beware of superimposing and of forcing the ideal right reaction over emotions that cannot as yet feel that way. Just observe, and little by little you will grow into true dignity by losing your sense of shame which, after all, is nothing but the reverse side of the inordinate pride of the idealized self-image. That cannot allow for any semblance of defeat. As your idealized self-image weakens, you will no longer command yourself to have to be victorious at all times in certain matters. Therefore you will not feel exposed and humiliated when you suffer defeat. You will thus gain true dignity. This will set you free. You no longer have to fight against impossible odds. You

no longer have to keep up a pretense. You no longer have to exhaust yourself senselessly to grab at victory that cannot be yours at all times. You no longer have to exhaust yourself at proving something. We have often discussed this proving current. Some of you now realize how much strength it takes for you. Some of you have already detected its existence.

At first, all this is difficult to find, notwithstanding that it is partly on the surface. You look away from it because it is so subtle and so easily camouflaged. And the less you are aware of it, the greater is the obstruction to freedom and strength, to happiness, inner health, and peace.

Now, are there any questions?

QUESTION: It is so very difficult to find only one trend in the emotions. For instance, when you feel humiliated, one set of emotions recognizes the other person and sees that what he did came perhaps out of his own insecurity. Then erupts another set of feelings that spell fury and anger. Between these two sets of feelings -- one forgiving and understanding, the other being angry -- there is always a conflict. How can one find out which is the right feeling?

ANSWER: I should think it is not too difficult to know which is the right feeling, provided both feelings are genuine. Of course, it may be that the first and obviously right reaction is superimposed. One tries to have it because one has recognized its theoretical value. But it is not yet felt. Therefore it is constantly being interfered with by the emotion that is still predominant, the childish proud one which is all the more persistent because one tries to superimpose it and does not allow it to fully reach surface awareness of the connected links, their cause and origin. The negative feeling has to be let out in its full impact. That does not mean one should act upon it, but you have to become aware of the intensity of the anger, the childish demands and claims, the real reason for one's anger (defeat being inadmissible). If these emotional reactions and impressions are allowed to come to the surface with all their childishness and irrational claims, without rationalizing and explaining them away, they will eventually weaken so that the other set of feelings will become genuine and more and more dominant. Often, if good will is superimposed, it becomes an obstruction unto itself. So, good will for purification has to be guided into the right channel. If used in the wrong way, it can be a hindrance and lead to a forceful, ungentle reaction and self-deception. Allow yourself to have all emotions come out without being a "policeman." Then and then only will it become utterly clear how outrageous and childish your demands are of others and of yourself, how you reject, at least emotionally, the world you live in, including yourself. You demand of yourself a perfection that you cannot yet have. And what you think you demand of the other, as I pointed out, is an externalization of your own demands of yourself. You reason that if the other were as he "should" be, then you in turn could be as you want to be, or think you ought to be: your idealized self. The anger at others is, in reality, nothing but a blame that serves to prevent you from being as you think you should be. Of course, all this is not consciously thought. It is not understood in the subconscious that if the idealized self were a reality and not a fake, you could not ever be prevented by others from being what you are. But the idealized self-image pretends. Often, the good will to superimpose ideal standards is a mixture of the true good intentions and the demands of the idealized self. Therefore it is prohibitive and does not allow the truth to come to the surface.

I cannot emphasize strongly enough that to recognize these childish emotions does not force you to act upon them. This is constantly being misunderstood. A wrong conclusion is prevalent

that to recognize and see, and then to act accordingly is one. Actually, this wrong conclusion also is a pretense. It is clung to under the guise of decency, while the underlying reason is the battle against seeing the falsity of the idealized self-image and against the reluctance in giving it up.

Often, the real self actually manifests, and what you described as the first set of feelings may not even be forcefully superimposed. It may be quite genuine, as it were. But one does not heed its voice. The compulsive pride of the idealized self-image exerts its rules, dictating to the personality to act accordingly. Then there is a case when a "should" is not even outwardly right and cannot be rationalized as being up to the spiritual standards one wants to abide by. One should be angry and unforgiving; one should despise and not understand; one should not be kind and loving, etc., etc. It can develop to the point where one should hate. This was discussed before and is a typical example of how unreal all negative emotions are. In the last analysis, all negative emotions are compulsive. There comes a time on this path when one clearly sees that. At this point, one may not yet be ready to let go of the compulsion, but one recognizes its nature and also recognizes the underlying reality, certainty, and stability of the real feeling slowly coming to the fore. Yet, a part of the personality still clings to the supposed "safety" of the negative reaction.

This holds true particularly with people who do not trust their emotions and intuitions, but put all their trust into their intellectual, volitional nature. At times, the intellect forbids hate and negative emotions. But whenever it can be rationalized and justified, the reason holds on to the superimposed, compulsive aspect and does not allow the feelings to guide you. Due to some instances in which you discovered negative instincts, you at one time made the mistake of concluding that all instincts and emotions are negative. Therefore you do not give the chance for growth to that which still needs growing in your intuitive nature. And that which is already constructive and mature is blocked by a superimposed level, vastly inferior to the intuition.

Such overemphasis on the reasoning power constantly prevents the real self from coming out. Thus you constantly and systematically discourage your inner nature from functioning, from guiding you; and you cling to that which seems safe, "the little pride."

QUESTION: Here is a question from an absentee which, I think, was already covered in part. I shall read it: "We present our idealized self-image to ourselves, as well as to the world. This must put intolerable strain on human relationships, as well as bring out lots of negative reactions. Could you talk to us about this and could you tell us how to recognize and accept the real self in the other person?"

ANSWER: Yes, it is, to a large extent, answered. Let me just add one more thing. It would be a grave mistake to set out thinking, "How can I recognize the real self in the other person?" You have a difficult enough job doing this with yourself. To do so with the other is quite impossible. But as you proceed and make progress in becoming aware of your own real self -- which comes only after sustained effort of discovering and understanding your idealized self -- to the degree of your progress do you automatically sense, experience, and reach the real self of the other person. And conversely, in the same way do your distortions affect and reach the corresponding distortions in the other person.

Therefore, how to recognize the real self in another person cannot be a process that can be cultivated and learned. It is a natural by-product of growth and awareness due to this work you do

with yourself. You become more seeing, more alert, more intuitive. It cannot be a volitional process. I venture to say that the person who asked that question would fall into the same category as the friend who put the last question wherein an overemphasis is placed on reason and the thought process rather than on feeling and intuition. The very fact that the question is asked, "How can we learn to recognize in the other person...etc.," is an indication of this inner situation.

QUESTION: Doesn't this correspondence between two real selves often happen in silence?

ANSWER: It can happen in any way, in any form of communication. If you now reread the lecture I gave some time ago on communication, you will find it to apply here. As your real self demonstrates or manifests, relaxed receptivity is a result of it and therefore reaches the inner self, or real self, of the other person. Contrarily, the grabbing, craving motion I described in tonight's lecture -- the distortion of the instinct of procreation -- causes the other person to withdraw because the movement is too grabbing. On the other hand, the distortion of the instinct of self-preservation -- creating the restrictive, holding back, inverted motion -- will prevent communication. So what has been said in all these recent lectures must tie in with communication. That is, one lecture must tie in and be intimately connected with any other.

Now, in what way communication occurs is entirely unimportant and will happen according to the situation at hand. It may be in silence; it may be in words; it may be through any of the human faculties used in interrelation and communication.

QUESTION: Many times a person is reluctant to change something about himself. It might be something either physical or psychological. He gives himself the excuse, "If I do change in such and such a way then I will no longer be myself." Is that a perversion of the first instinct?

ANSWER: You are quite right. The perversion of the first instinct is resistant to any change and to growth. That is its nature. It is static and tends towards stagnation. All of you who do this work have experienced it, and traditional psychoanalysis in any form knows it too. The resistance to change is one of the greatest hurdles to be overcome. It can be rationalized in many ways, but whatever is the conscious "reason" for such resistance, deep down you all battle against giving up the "glory" of your idealized self. That, especially, you fear above and beyond anything else. You think or feel you have to hold on to it for dear life because, after all, it was chosen as a "solution." And since this process of choice was unconscious, the same unconscious reasons still make you hold on to the belief that perhaps, after all, it may still turn out to be a "solution" and bring you safety and security (distortion of the instinct of self-preservation), as well as happiness and pleasure (distortion of the instinct of procreation). This is always the underlying force of your resistance, no matter what the outer rationalizations are. In the first place, to find that this resistance exists is important enough. But then this deep underlying reason has to come to awareness, for only then will it prove to be an unworkable solution that you have chosen, and you will give it up little by little. As long as the real reason for resistance to change is unconscious, it is not amenable to change, correction, or reconsideration since anything activated out of the unconscious is resistive to reality. While you may consciously have some new ideas, change certain aspects, attitudes, and approaches to life, this part that is hidden within yourself has remained static and has battled with the other part. Unconsciously you hold on to that which was chosen as salvation and safety, the pseudosolution. That makes change, growth, and liberation so extremely difficult.

The reason you cited is just one of many other possible "excuses" or rationalizations. As to the value of this particular rationalization -- fear of not remaining oneself -- I do not think that you need any further elucidation on it. It hardly stands up, for just the opposite is true. The more conflicted a person is, the less is he his real self. Change and growth will bring the real self into the foreground. And this real self will in no way feel strange, for you are, of course, permeated with it in spite of all the distortions.

QUESTION: In this process of self-improvement, the more we understand others and forgive, the more will our emotional reactions become rather toned down. Don't we thus tend to level off all our emotions in some way, as to anger or other strong emotions that we may have? Our emotions will not be as strong anymore.

ANSWER: It is difficult to generalize. A certain stage of development does bring it about, of course. Your violent emotions do tone down. You genuinely feel more serene. But it should always be kept in mind that such serenity may be artificial, while actually, unconsciously, you are seething with strong repressed emotions. These have to reach the surface consciousness before they can be properly assimilated and be really dispensed with.

For example, if someone is very much afraid of his emotions, he may believe his lack of strong negative feelings is a sign of spiritual progress and emotional growth. So it cannot be judged whether lack of anger or other negative emotions is a sign of growth and harmony, or whether it is a sign of repression. It may be either artificial or genuine. The very first step in growth and the process of gaining maturity is to become aware of emotions you may never have thought you had.

QUESTION: My question was really that this would ultimately develop to the extent where we have less strong reactions?

ANSWER: No, that is not so. Only as far as negative emotions are concerned. To make the goal that of leveling off of negative emotions, I would say yes. Eventually true serenity will bring this about. But I might say it is always a dangerous process to take on a distant goal when you first have to attain nearer goals. The dangers are manifold. For instance, you may be tempted to skip a very necessary phase that is unpleasant at the moment, but without which you cannot reach the ultimate goal. It may lead to further, increased self-deception, the very same self-deception you want to uncover. This should be one of the near goals. Only gradually can further goals be envisaged until true serenity will come by itself. The view of the far goal may enlarge the idealized self-image. So the near goal should be the next step, not the end result. The near goal would be "I want to become aware of what really is in me." When that is accomplished to some degree, the next goal will present itself.

It is just as with the wanderer, the mountain climber. If he is wise, he will not set out with the final goal in view. The distant summit he eventually wants to reach may take days and weeks of hard climbing, ascent, and endurance. By contemplating this long distance, he will get tired before he begins. He may then lie down and dream that he is walking up. The dream may seem very real, but in reality he is not moving one inch forward because he is too tired to reach the top before he even gets started. But if, on the other hand, he sets his goals hour by hour where he can see the objective, rest, and then proceed again, he will not become exhausted. He will not have to deceive himself by only dreaming he is moving up. This is what I have to say.

May you all derive further instruction and benefit from these words. May these words open further vistas, further doors, further understanding. May they strengthen you a little more to face yourself as you are now. For nothing will be as life-giving, life-preserving, and as conducive to true pleasure and happiness as your inner truth. Be in peace, my dearest ones. Be blessed. Be in God!

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